MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA AUTOMATION ENGINEER | DEVOPS & CI/CD INFRASTRUCTURE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience and a strong DevOps focus in CI/CD, Kubernetes-based test infrastructure and build tooling. Owns and operates GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams and builds and maintains ephemeral test environments deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster. Delivers measurable improvements in pipeline performance and CI runner costs, and develops personal infrastructure projects with k3s, GitOps, monitoring and Terraform. Targeting a move into DevOps or platform engineering.

SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm
Infrastructure and cloud: Kubernetes (namespace-level access and test-environment deployments), k3s, Terraform (personal project), Argo CD, Ansible (basic), AWS (EC2 and S3 basics; personal learning)
Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Scripting and systems: Python, Bash, Linux, Git
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman, Java (test code)

SELECTED PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health Software | 2023-2024

- Built short-lived environments for each merge request, with the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Configured automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments for feature review and e2e testing.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health Software | 2022

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split e2e tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by approximately 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024-2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS; provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health Software | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the most frequent offenders.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw | 2021-Present

- Owns and operates GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams, approximately 25 developers, covering build, unit, integration and e2e test stages and artifact publishing.
- Maintains a pytest and Playwright e2e suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Writes Python and Bash tooling for seeding test data into PostgreSQL.
- Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, used in onboarding, and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw | 2019-2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project and configured Jenkins jobs for nightly runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018-2019

- Investigated customer issues in logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Preparing for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam, scheduled for January 2027